

different outcome. That's why most people drift through life in what is described by Dominick Quartuccio as a "hypnotic rhythm."

Quartuccio is a life coach and author of the book *Design Your Future*. He talked to Brad and Jonathan about the concept of *awakenings*, noting life-changing events that thrust themselves upon us—like the death of a loved one, a cancer diagnosis, or unexpectedly losing a job—lead to nearly 99 percent of awakenings that lead to behavioral changes. Unfortunately, it often takes something that shakes a person to their core to be the catalyst for change.

Dominick states that taking action is the differentiator between having an awakening and simply being aware. Everyone is aware that smoking is bad for your health, but many people continue to smoke until they receive a cancer diagnosis. *Then* their awakening occurs, and they stop smoking.

An example of such a financial awakening shared on the podcast was the story of Joel and Alexis, authors of the *Financial 180* blog. Joel and Alexis were a couple of young engineers living on the Florida coast, mindlessly blowing through their incomes with no idea where their money was going. Joel pointed out, "When you get into a routine, and you do something long enough, it just starts to